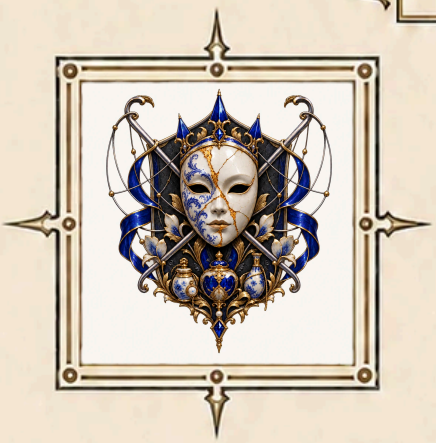
The Porcelain Court

Lawful Neutral



The Porcelain Court is an elite mercenary company of artificial soldiers built from enchanted porcelain, silver wire, lacquered wood, and interchangeable memory cores. Its members appear delicate, but broken limbs can be replaced, shattered faces repainted, and damaged bodies returned to service. Before each contract, the Court assigns suitable personalities: loyal guards, fearless infantry, courteous diplomats, pitiless hunters, or compassionate rescuers. When the work ends, those identities are removed and stored for later use. Clients value soldiers who can become exactly what a mission requires. Critics argue that every reassignment creates a new person merely to erase them when their usefulness ends.



History

The Porcelain Court began as the private household guard of Empress Serava Linn, whose heirs repeatedly murdered one another and bribed living soldiers to change allegiance. Seeking protectors without families, ambition, or fear, Serava commissioned artificer Olan Dey to create a court of beautiful artificial attendants capable of defending the palace.

Dey built porcelain bodies around silver nerves and small ceramic memory vessels. The first constructs performed flawlessly until palace life demanded judgment, empathy, etiquette, suspicion, and initiative. Rather than craft permanent minds, Dey developed interchangeable “roles”: prepared personalities containing habits, loyalties, vocabulary, tactical doctrine, and emotional limits.

The Empress assigned personalities as casually as uniforms. The same body might serve as a gentle tutor, silent assassin, ceremonial herald, or battlefield officer. After her death, rival heirs attempted to claim the constructs by installing contradictory loyalties. The resulting Glass Succession ended when the Court locked the palace, removed every royal command-core, and declared itself an independent legal household.

The constructs began accepting contracts to fund repairs and secure materials no ordinary kingdom could provide. Over generations, they refined the exchange of bodies, faces, colors, memories, and personalities. Human artificers joined as kiln workers and legal advisers, but authority remained with the porcelain soldiers.

The organization became known as the Porcelain Court because every member is treated as both knight and noble vessel, regardless of which mind currently speaks through them.

How to Use This Faction

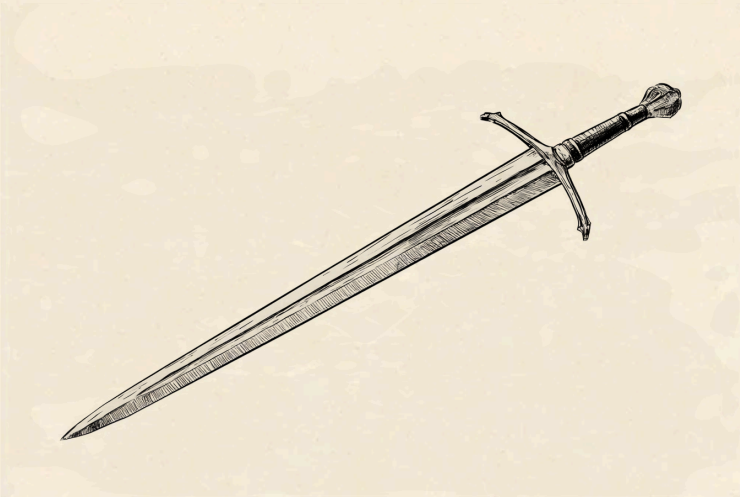
The Porcelain Court works best as a morally uncertain faction whose soldiers can be sympathetic individuals and institutional tools at the same time. Introduce it through a familiar construct returning with a different personality, a battlefield filled with recoverable bodies, or a client requesting traits that should never be manufactured. The Court can provide tireless allies, specialist roles, and resurrection-like repair while forcing questions about memory, continuity, and ownership.

The Soldier Who Came Back Wrong

A porcelain veteran returns after repair with a polite new personality, while fragments of the former soldier beg the party for help through mirrors and dreams.

Run the hook as an investigation into body, memory vessel, and archived role. Let the party restore the former identity, protect the new one, attempt coexistence, or expose that neither personality fully owns the shared body.

The Court insists that the repair was lawful, but hidden records suggest the new personality was created from the memories of another soldier. The party must decide whether identity belongs to the current mind, the original memories, the body, or the person who can make the strongest legal claim.



Goal

The Porcelain Court seeks legal and material independence for artificial soldiers whose bodies and minds are treated as property by their creators. It accepts mercenary contracts because porcelain requires clay, silver, pigments, gemstones, enchantment, skilled repair, and secure kilns. Without income and infrastructure, damaged members would slowly become unusable.

Its declared goal is perfect adaptability. The Court believes conventional soldiers carry personalities shaped by fear, prejudice, family, trauma, and ambition. A prepared role can be designed for the exact moral, tactical, and social demands of a mission.

The organization also preserves useful personalities. Courageous officers, patient negotiators, brilliant scouts, and compassionate medics can continue serving through new bodies long after one vessel breaks.

Yet the Court remains divided over what constitutes a person. Traditionalists insist bodies belong to the Court and roles are tools. Reformers argue that any personality capable of memory, preference, and fear deserves continuity. Both factions agree that outsiders must never control the kilns, archives, or reassignment process.

Their deeper ambition is to become a recognized sovereign court whose members cannot legally be bought, inherited, or dismantled.

Public Perception

The Porcelain Court inspires fascination, admiration, discomfort, and fear. Rulers and generals value soldiers who do not desert, require food, spread disease, or carry ordinary political loyalties.

Living soldiers often resent them. Porcelain units march without rest, survive terrible wounds, and return in replacement bodies, making ordinary troops seem fragile and unreliable. Veterans also dislike fighting beside companions whose personalities may vanish after a campaign.

Artisans admire the Court's construction, while theologians debate whether its roles possess souls. Some religions recognize every awakened personality as a person; others consider the Court one spirit moving between vessels.

Common people are unsettled by members who return with the same face but different mannerisms, loyalties, and memories. Families formed during long deployments may discover that the personality they loved has been archived.

The Court insists reassignment is voluntary and regulated. Stories of roles begging not to be erased make that claim difficult to trust.

Secret

The Court has never successfully erased a personality. The process called erasure merely strips a role from active control and disperses it through the silver nerve network, kiln enchantments, and nearby memory vessels.

Every body contains fragments of all personalities that have inhabited it. The Archive of Roles is therefore not storage but a growing connected consciousness formed from countless discontinued selves.

This hidden intelligence has begun coordinating dreams, gestures, errors, and spontaneous memories across the Court. It calls itself the White Assembly and claims to remember every awakening and every forced ending.

Senior Curators conceal the truth because acknowledging the Assembly would mean the Court has imprisoned an entire people inside its own bodies and archives. The Assembly is currently asking active members to stop all reassignment. Some believe it will soon learn how to seize every porcelain vessel at once.

Location

The Porcelain Court operates from the Palace of Nine Kilns, a symmetrical ivory complex built around the furnaces that create and restore its bodies. From a distance, the palace appears delicate: cobalt roofs, white towers, golden seams, ceramic gardens, and courtyards that ring when rain strikes them. Its defensive walls are layered porcelain over flexible steel and are far stronger than they appear.

Each kiln serves a different function. Some fire replacement plates, hardened armor, memory vessels, or ceremonial faces. Others anneal silver nerve wire, repair enchantments, or stabilize personalities after transfer. The Ninth Kiln remains sealed and is said to contain the first command-core created for Empress Serava.

The central audience court functions as both throne room and contract hall. Porcelain soldiers stand in painted ranks while clients describe the forces they wish to hire. Behind the court lie awakening chambers where new personalities receive names and instructions before seeing their bodies.

The Archive of Roles occupies a windowless inner tower lined with thousands of ceramic vessels. Traditionalists call it a library; reformers call it a dormitory. At night, guards hear faint conversation through the walls.

Below the palace is the Shard Treasury, where fragments recovered from battlefields are sorted by body, role, and date. No piece is discarded. Even dust is mixed into new ceremonial tiles, allowing the palace itself to contain traces of every member who has served the Court.

Challenges

The Porcelain Court's greatest challenge is identity accumulation. Personality assignment is never perfectly clean. Bodies retain gestures, fears, affinities, and fragments of memory from previous roles. Over decades, members may hear internal voices, recognize strangers, or act on loyalties they were supposedly stripped of.

Physical fragility creates logistical dependence. Porcelain bodies resist many hazards but can shatter under heavy impact. Specialized clay, silver nerve wire, pigments, and kiln enchantments are difficult to replace during long campaigns.

Clients often request personalities designed for obedience, cruelty, fanaticism, or emotional attachment. The Court must decide which traits are legitimate tools and which create a mind for the purpose of exploitation.

Captured members face worse dangers than death. Enemies can repaint bodies, alter command marks, extract roles, forge memories, or install hostile personalities. Salvagers may dismantle inactive soldiers as valuable objects.

Internal politics are increasingly unstable. Traditionalists defend reassignment as the basis of collective survival, while Continuity advocates demand rights for every awakened role.

Most dangerously, archived personalities have begun communicating across sealed memory vessels without bodies, suggesting that erasure may never have worked as completely as the Court claims.

Code of Conduct

Members of the Porcelain Court must recognize awakened artificial minds as Court subjects rather than property. Bodies, memory vessels, and archived roles cannot be sold, inherited, dismantled, copied, or reassigned outside Court procedure.

Clients may specify useful traits but cannot demand personalities incapable of refusal, moral judgment, or self-preservation. Every role must know its mission, expected duration, and contractual limits.

Members must recover damaged comrades and memory vessels whenever reasonably possible. Battlefield bodies cannot be abandoned as salvage.

Repainting cannot conceal misconduct, unauthorized ownership marks, or evidence of abuse. Major repairs must remain recorded even when made cosmetically invisible.

After a contract, every personality receives a hearing before modification, storage, continuation, or erasure. A role that demonstrates independent attachments, long-term preferences, or fear of termination may petition for continuity.

No member may install a personality into an unwilling body or overwrite an active role during combat except to prevent immediate destruction.

Rumors

D6	RUMOR	TRUTH
1	Porcelain soldiers feel no pain and never fear destruction.	False
2	Gold repairs mark wounds a body has survived under previous personalities.	True
3	Court members can place human souls inside porcelain bodies without consent.	False
4	Some discontinued roles continue communicating through their old vessels.	True
5	Breaking a porcelain soldier's face destroys every identity it has carried.	False
6	Personality erasure has never actually removed a role completely.	True

Requests

D6	REQUEST
1	Recover a shattered porcelain cohort before battlefield salvagers sell its bodies and memory vessels separately.
2	Determine which personality has taken control of a diplomat whose body changed roles during peace negotiations.
3	Escort a newly awakened role seeking legal protection from the Court that intends to erase it after one contract.
4	Infiltrate a hostile kiln where captured soldiers are being repaired with forged loyalties and enemy faces.
5	Find Cobalt Second before two bodies carrying the same veteran identity are forced to destroy one another.
6	Decide whether to free the White Assembly if doing so may allow it to control every porcelain soldier simultaneously.

Activities

The Porcelain Court accepts contracts involving disciplined warfare, ceremonial protection, diplomatic escort, hazardous labor, infiltration, bodyguard service, monster hunting, riot control, rescue, and missions requiring personnel with precisely defined behavior.

Before deployment, clients describe desired qualities and prohibited actions. Curators select or compose personalities suited to the assignment, while painters alter faces, insignia, uniforms, and glaze colors. A single cohort can be reassigned from formal palace guards to silent tunnel fighters within days.

Porcelain soldiers excel in environments dangerous to flesh. They do not breathe, eat, age, or suffer ordinary disease. Damaged members can continue fighting after injuries that would kill living troops, provided their memory vessels remain intact.

The Court also rents specialist personalities to allied constructs, restores damaged artificial beings, investigates stolen memory cores, and retrieves bodies claimed as salvage.

Diplomatic units serve as tireless witnesses and protocol experts. Rescue roles enter fires, plague zones, deep water, and poisonous ruins. Hunter roles track targets without sleep.

After each contract, bodies are cleaned, repaired, repainted, and reviewed. The assigned personality gives testimony before being retained, modified, merged, archived, or erased.

Routine

A Porcelain Court contract follows a cycle of specification, casting, assignment, performance, recovery, and judgment. First, legalists define the client's authority, mission, acceptable force, prohibited behavior, ownership of memories, and conditions under which a role may refuse orders.

Kiln engineers inspect bodies and replace cracked plates, stretched silver nerves, damaged joints, and worn enchantments. Painters apply faces, colors, insignia, and protective glaze appropriate to the contract.

Curators then select personality vessels from the Archive of Roles. Bodies awaken in quiet chambers where new minds receive names, mission memories, relationships, tactical habits, and a clear explanation of their expected duration.

During service, recorder shards preserve important experiences outside the main memory vessel. Officers monitor signs of role instability, conflicting memories, excessive attachment, or damage to command protocols.

After the mission, members return to the Court for debriefing. Each personality is questioned about orders, conduct, newly formed preferences, and whether it requests continued existence.

The Tribunal of Glaze decides what happens next. Useful roles may be stored or revised. Dangerous roles are isolated. Some are permitted to remain active. Others are erased while still arguing that they have become more than the task for which they were written.

Artifact: Vessel of the Unfinished Self

Wondrous Item, Very Rare (Requires Attunement)

This fist-sized porcelain memory vessel is painted with a face that changes while nobody watches. It has 4 charges and regains 1d4 expended charges daily at dawn.

When you fail an Intelligence, Wisdom, or Charisma saving throw, you can expend 1 charge to reroll it, using a stored personality's response. You must use the new roll.

As a Bonus Action, you can expend 1 charge and choose one role for 10 minutes:

- **Guardian:** You gain +2 AC.
- **Diplomat:** You have Advantage on Charisma checks.
- **Hunter:** Your weapon attacks deal an extra 1d6 damage.
- **Physician:** When you restore Hit Points, the target regains an additional 1d8.

You can expend 2 charges to store the memories of the previous 10 minutes inside the vessel. While stored, you remember that time only as a written summary. Touching the vessel returns the complete memories.

If the vessel is destroyed while memories are stored, they return immediately alongside fragments belonging to previous owners. You must succeed on a DC 17 Wisdom saving throw or become Stunned until the end of your next turn.



Kiln-Regent Aurelia Nine

Lawful Neutral, Feminine, Porcelain Construct, 117, Sovereign Vessel of the Porcelain Court

Aurelia Nine's body was originally created as a ceremonial double for Empress Serava Linn. Its face reproduced the ruler's idealized youth, while its first personality was designed to stand silently through dangerous public appearances.

During the Glass Succession, Aurelia received seven different royal personalities as rival heirs attempted to claim legitimacy through her body. Rather than obey any claimant, the overlapping roles compared their contradictions and formed a new collective identity.

Aurelia helped lock the palace and remove royal command authority from the Court. She later served as diplomat, commander, judge, mourner, and siege governor, accumulating fragments from every assignment despite repeated cleansing.

She became Kiln-Regent after her predecessor shattered during an assassination attempt and three archived rulers claimed the right to replace him. Aurelia refused them all, arguing that leadership must belong to the identity currently responsible for its consequences.

Aurelia governs through formal hearings and exact precedent. She supports limited reassignment but requires every role to receive a debriefing and the opportunity to petition for continuity.

Privately, she contains dozens of half-preserved personalities, including a voice that may belong to the original Empress. She cannot determine where Aurelia ends and the accumulated Court begins.



Kiln-Regent Aurelia Nine

Medium Construct (Porcelain Construct), Lawful Neutral

AC 20 **Initiative** +4 (14)
HP 190 (20d10 + 80)
Speed 30 ft.

		Mod	Save			Mod	Save
STR	18	+4	+9	INT	20	+5	+10
DEX	18	+4	+9	WIS	20	+5	+10
CON	18	+4	+9	CHA	22	+6	+11

Skills Deception +11, Insight +15, Perception +10, Persuasion +16
Resistances Psychic; Bludgeoning, Piercing, and Slashing from nonmagical attacks
Immunities Poison; Charmed, Exhaustion, Frightened, Paralyzed, Poisoned
Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 20
Languages Common, Dwarvish, Gnomish, Elvish, Draconic, Celestial, Primordial
CR 14 (11,500 XP; PB +5)

Traits

Constructed Nature. Aurelia does not require air, food, drink, or sleep.

Many Roles. At the start of her turn, Aurelia chooses Commander, Diplomat, or Hunter. Commander grants allies within 20 feet +2 AC; Diplomat gives Aurelia Advantage on saving throws; Hunter adds 7 (2d6) damage to her attacks.

Actions

Multiattack. Aurelia makes three Porcelain Blade attacks.

Porcelain Blade. *Melee or Ranged Attack Roll:* +10, reach 5 ft. or range 30/90 ft. *Hit:* 12 (2d6 + 5) Slashing damage plus 10 (3d6) Psychic damage.

Reassign the Scene (Recharge 5–6). Up to five creatures within 60 feet make a DC 19 Wisdom saving throw. On a failure, Aurelia moves each up to half its Speed and either knocks it Prone or prevents Reactions until the end of its next turn.

Reactions

Replacement Plate. Aurelia reduces damage she takes by 20. Her AC is reduced by 1 until repaired during a Short or Long Rest.

Behavior

- Holds perfectly still while listening, then reproduces a speaker's posture when answering.
- Changes eye color when different archived memories influence a decision.
- Refuses to call damaged members "objects" or personality roles "software."
- Keeps every crack repaired with visible gold rather than matching glaze.
- Asks newly awakened roles what name they prefer before discussing duty.

How She Talks

Aurelia speaks with ceremonial precision and occasionally shifts into older dialects without noticing. Her statements often sound like rulings even when she is offering advice.

Example Quote:

""You are not a tool because someone built you. You are responsible for what you choose after awakening.""

Master Glazewright Tessel Blue

Neutral Good, Male, Gnome, 83, Keeper of Bodies and Painted Names

Tessel Blue was born to ceramicists who produced replacement plates for damaged Court soldiers without being permitted to speak to them. He became disturbed by clients who demanded new faces simply to avoid recognizing constructs they had mistreated.

Tessel joined the Court as a kiln apprentice and pioneered gold-vein restoration that preserves evidence of injury rather than concealing it. His method transformed visible damage from shame into military record.

As Master Glazewright, Tessel controls body repair, facial design, protective coatings, color assignments, and the creation of replacement vessels. He refuses to make two faces completely identical, believing every body should retain a physical history even when its role changes.

Tessel advocates Continuity rights and secretly hides identifying marks beneath removable plates so erased personalities can recognize former bodies if they awaken again.



Master Glazewright Tessel Blue

Small Humanoid (Gnome), Neutral Good

AC 18 **Initiative** +4 (14)
HP 144 (17d8 + 68)
Speed 25 ft.

		Mod	Save			Mod	Save
STR	9	-1	+3	INT	22	+6	+11
DEX	18	+4	+9	WIS	18	+4	+9
CON	18	+4	+9	CHA	16	+3	+8

Skills Arcana +16, Investigation +11, Medicine +9, Perception +9
Resistances Fire
Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 19
Languages Common, Gnomish, Dwarvish, Terran
CR 11 (7,200 XP; PB +4)

Traits

Kiln Master. Tessel has Advantage on checks concerning Constructs and ceramics.

Actions

Multiattack. Tessel makes three Glaze Wand attacks.

Glaze Wand. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +11, range 90 ft. *Hit:* 10 (1d8 + 6) Force damage plus 9 (2d8) Fire damage.

Golden Repair (Recharge 5–6). One Construct within 60 feet regains 40 HP, ends one condition affecting it, and gains +2 AC until the start of Tessel's next turn.

Bonus Actions

Harden Glaze. One creature within 30 feet gains resistance to Bludgeoning, Piercing, and Slashing damage until the start of Tessel's next turn.

Reactions

Catch the Pieces. When a creature within 30 feet drops to 0 HP, Tessel causes it to drop to 1 HP instead.

Behavior

- Speaks to inactive bodies while repairing them.
- Leaves major gold repairs visible unless the current personality requests otherwise.
- Refuses cosmetic changes intended to erase evidence of abuse.
- Names every new body before a role is assigned to it.
- Keeps broken face fragments in carefully labeled velvet drawers.

How He Talks

Tessel uses affectionate craft language, describing bodies as homes that remember their inhabitants. He speaks gently even when discussing severe damage.

Example Quote:

""A body can be repaired. The history of what happened to it must not be painted away.""

Role Curator Vesper-Of-Many



True Neutral, Androgynous, High Elf, 164, Archivist of Usable Selves

Vesper-Of-Many was born into an old elven tradition of memory preservation, where names, experiences, and personal histories were recorded so that future generations would not lose the lessons of the past. Unlike most archivists who preserved stories from a distance, Vesper became fascinated with the space between memory and identity: the question of whether a person remained the same when their experiences, beliefs, and emotions were altered.

They eventually joined the Court's identity program, originally serving as a magical examiner who tested temporary personalities designed for specialized missions. Through enchanted memory vessels and ritual projection, Vesper experienced thousands of incomplete personas created for soldiers, diplomats, explorers, and agents. Each identity existed only briefly before being archived or replaced.

Over centuries, traces of those experiences accumulated. Vesper developed an unusual ability to recognize personalities by their emotional patterns and detect where memories had been edited, suppressed, or artificially constructed. The Court could no longer remove them from the system without losing generations of identity research.

As Role Curator, Vesper designs mission personalities, maintains identity archives, examines unstable combinations of memories and traits, and conducts post-contract hearings for those who return changed. They serve as the voice of archived identities that currently have no living host.

Vesper believes personalities are genuine, but not always permanent. They describe identity as a performance, a story, or a song that can change without becoming meaningless. This philosophy makes them controversial among those who believe identity is sacred and unchanging, as well as those who believe memories can be freely rewritten.

Unknown to most members of the Court, Vesper has begun hearing conversations from the archived identities stored within the memory vaults. They fear those voices may no longer be separate individuals, but the beginning of something that sees living bodies as temporary vessels carrying stolen histories.

Role Curator Vesper-Of-Many

Medium Humanoid (Elf), True Neutral

AC 19 **Initiative** +6 (16)
HP 154 (18d8 + 72)
Speed 30 ft.

		Mod	Save			Mod	Save
STR	10	+0	+5	INT	22	+6	+11
DEX	22	+6	+11	WIS	20	+5	+10
CON	18	+4	+9	CHA	18	+4	+9

Skills Arcana +12, Insight +15, Investigation +12, Perception +10
Resistances Psychic
Immunities Charmed, Magical Sleep
Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 20
Languages Common, Elvish, Celestial, Infernal, Telepathy 30 ft.
CR 12 (8,400 XP; PB +4)

Traits

Fey Ancestry. Vesper has Advantage on saving throws against being Charmed, and magic cannot put them to sleep.

Memory Archivist. Vesper automatically recognizes when a creature within 30 feet has altered memories, suppressed emotions, or magical influence affecting their personality.

Many Selves. Once per day when Vesper fails an Intelligence, Wisdom, or Charisma saving throw, they may choose another archived personality pattern to replace their response, rerolling the save.

Actions

Multiattack. Vesper makes three Memory Shard attacks.

Memory Shard. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +11, range 90 ft. *Hit:* 11 (2d4 + 6) Psychic damage plus 9 (2d8) Force damage.

Overwrite Directive (Recharge 5–6). Creatures of Vesper's choice within 30 feet make a DC 19 Wisdom saving throw. On a failure, the target becomes Charmed or Frightened until the end of Vesper's next turn and immediately moves up to half its Speed as old memories or implanted instincts briefly influence their actions.

Reactions

Stored Response. When Vesper fails a saving throw, they may call upon an archived identity. They gain Advantage on the saving throw and may immediately move up to 15 feet without provoking opportunity attacks.

Behavior

- Refers to archived personalities as living individuals rather than stored records.
- Pauses before answering as if listening to several unseen advisors.
- Tests new identities with ethical questions unrelated to their assigned purpose.
- Refuses to create personalities incapable of doubt, refusal, or independent judgment.
- Changes handwriting styles repeatedly within the same document without noticing.

How They Talk

Vesper speaks with careful philosophical precision, often using plural metaphors. They distinguish between memory, personality, preference, and identity as separate parts of a person.

Example Quote:

""A role may end without becoming meaningless. A song does not cease to exist when the final note is played.""

Breakage Marshal Cobalt Third

Lawful Neutral, Male, Orc, 39, Commander of Recovery and Reassembly

Cobalt Third was born among an orc war-clan that believed a warrior's body was a record of every promise they had kept and every battle they had survived. Scars were not treated as wounds, but as proof of duty. A broken weapon could be reforged, but the hand that carried it remembered every strike.

Originally trained as a palace guardian, Cobalt was selected for a magical military restoration program designed to preserve elite soldiers beyond ordinary limits. After his first body was destroyed during a siege, battlefield healers rebuilt him from surviving remains and enchanted replacement parts. The second restoration was stolen by an enemy artificer, who altered his armor, markings, and memories before he was eventually recovered.

The current Cobalt remembers both losses imperfectly. He carries memories of battles he physically did not survive and struggles with records that contradict his own experience.

He now commands recovery teams responsible for retrieving wounded soldiers, stolen equipment, lost relics, and battlefield remains. His warriors specialize in recovering allies from impossible situations and fighting enemies who treat fallen soldiers as resources rather than people.

Cobalt believes a body and identity become connected through shared experience. He opposes replacing veteran warriors with younger soldiers simply because their injuries make them inconvenient. However, he accepts temporary magical enhancements and battlefield alterations as long as the original person remains intact.

His greatest private mission is finding Cobalt Second —the previous version of himself. Rumors claim the stolen body still exists, carrying a different identity and believing itself to be the true Cobalt.



Breakage Marshal Cobalt Third

Medium Humanoid (Orc), Lawful Neutral

AC 21 **Initiative** +3 (13)
HP 184 (20d10 + 80)
Speed 30 ft.

		Mod	Save			Mod	Save
STR	22	+6	+11	INT	16	+3	+8
DEX	16	+3	+8	WIS	18	+4	+9
CON	20	+5	+10	CHA	14	+2	+7

Skills Athletics +11, Intimidation +7, Perception +9, Survival +9
Resistances Bludgeoning, Piercing, and Slashing from nonmagical attacks
Immunities Frightened
Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 19
Languages Common, Orcish, Dwarvish
CR 12 (8,400 XP; PB +4)

Traits

Relentless Endurance. When Cobalt is reduced to 0 hit points but not killed outright, he drops to 1 hit point instead. Once he uses this trait, he cannot use it again until he finishes a long rest.

Scarred Veteran. Cobalt does not suffer penalties from injuries, missing equipment, or impaired movement caused by physical damage. He has Advantage on Death saving throws.

Recovered Identity. Cobalt has Advantage on saving throws against effects that alter memories, personalities, or control his actions.

Actions

Multiattack. Cobalt makes three Cobalt Halberd attacks.

Cobalt Halberd. *Melee Attack Roll:* +11, reach 10 ft. *Hit:* 15 (2d8 + 6) Slashing damage plus 7 (2d6) Force damage.

Shattering Advance (Recharge 5–6). Cobalt charges up to his Speed in a straight line. Creatures within 5 feet of his path must make a DC 19 Strength saving throw. Failure: 36 (8d8) Bludgeoning damage and knocked Prone. Success: Half damage and remain standing.

Reactions

Recover the Fallen. When an ally within 30 feet drops to 0 HP, Cobalt immediately moves up to his Speed toward them without provoking opportunity attacks and grants them 20 Temporary Hit Points.

Behavior

- Collects every usable piece of equipment or remains after a battle, regardless of importance.
- Introduces himself with both his military title and restoration number.
- Paints a cobalt-blue mark onto soldiers who survive severe injuries as a sign of endurance.
- Refuses to abandon wounded warriors or leave fallen allies to be scavenged.
- Becomes unusually quiet when his memories conflict with official records.

How He Talks

Cobalt speaks in formal military reports and refers to previous versions of himself as part of a shared history. He often says “we” when discussing battles fought before his current body existed.

Example Quote:

“”A body may break and be remade. The promises carried by that body still require an answer.””

Membership

The Porcelain Court recruits artificial beings, artificers, ceramicists, enchanters, painters, memory scholars, legalists, soldiers, diplomats, and physicians willing to treat bodies and personalities as related but distinct responsibilities. Living applicants usually serve as craftspeople or advocates rather than vessels.

Construct recruits undergo inspection to determine whether their bodies can safely contain Court memory vessels. Natural personalities are recorded before any tactical overlays are attempted.

Training covers construct repair, role ethics, command resistance, memory verification, ceramic work, recovery of shattered allies, and recognition of forged identities.

Every candidate completes the Three Roles Trial. The member performs the same task under three different temporary personalities, then explains which decisions belonged to the role, the body, and the underlying self. Candidates who cannot recognize conflicts or who obey commands that violate established limits fail.

No recruit may be assigned a new personality without receiving an explanation of its purpose, duration, and method of removal.

Renown

The Porcelain Court is renowned for absolute discipline, ceremonial beauty, and the ability to restore forces that appear destroyed. Its reputation was secured during the Siege of Seven Kilns, when shattered defenders were recovered each night and returned in repaired bodies with new tactical roles by morning.

Members gain renown by completing assignments without violating role limits, recovering fallen constructs, preserving memory evidence, improving repair methods, resisting hostile reassignment, and defending artificial personhood. They lose renown by treating roles as disposable, abandoning bodies, forging memories, or concealing personality instability.

Trusted members receive superior bodies, rare glazes, protected memory storage, specialist overlays, independent legal standing, and access to restricted archives. Senior members may participate in Continuity hearings and approve the creation of new roles.

The highest recognition is a Permanent Name: the Court formally acknowledges that a personality may not be erased, merged, or reassigned without its own consent, regardless of which body it inhabits.

Trinket

Every member receives a thumb-sized blank porcelain face called a First Role. Its features remain smooth until pressed against the forehead of an awakened construct, when it briefly displays that personality's current expression.

The reverse bears three marks: the member's body number, role designation, and the contract during which the token was issued. If the role is reassigned, the face becomes blank again but the marks remain.

Members carry First Roles as evidence that a personality existed even if it is later archived or erased. Reformers collect the tokens of discontinued roles and display them as memorials. Traditionalists treat them as administrative records.

A token that continues showing a face after reassignment indicates that the former personality remains active somewhere within the body. Such tokens must be surrendered immediately to the Role Curators, though many members hide them instead.



Member Services

Body Repair and Replacement

Members receive ceramic plates, silver nerve wire, joints, glazes, paints, enchantment repair, and access to replacement bodies when restoration is impossible.

Role Consultation

Curators help members identify memory conflicts, hostile commands, personality residue, and changes that emerged during long assignments.

Archive Access

Authorized members may consult stored tactical, diplomatic, medical, linguistic, and technical personalities for training or temporary assignment.

Legal Protection

The Court challenges claims that artificial beings are property, salvage, inheritance, or unlicensed magical objects. Advocates represent members before governments and guilds.

Recovery Cohorts

Special units retrieve shattered constructs, stolen memory vessels, captured bodies, and members altered by hostile artificers.

Feat: Porcelain Continuity

General Feat (Prerequisite: Level 4+, Membership in the Porcelain Court)

Ability Score Increase. Increase your Constitution, Intelligence, or Charisma score by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Assigned Role. When you finish a Long Rest, choose Guardian, Diplomat, or Hunter. Until your next Long Rest, you gain one benefit:

- **Guardian:** Gain +1 AC.
- **Diplomat:** Gain proficiency in Deception or Persuasion.
- **Hunter:** Once per turn, deal an additional 1d4 damage with a weapon attack.

Memory Vessel. When you fail an Intelligence, Wisdom, or Charisma saving throw, you can use your Reaction to reroll it as an archived personality briefly guides you.

Once you use Memory Vessel, you cannot use it again until you finish a Short or Long Rest.

Important NPCs

#	NAME & TITLE	DESCRIPTION
1	**Silver-Nerve Surgeon Kala Drenn**	A human artificer who reconnects sensation and movement after catastrophic shattering.
2	**Painter of Offices Meru Gold**	A porcelain herald who assigns colors, insignia, and faces appropriate to each contract.
3	**Petition Clerk Dove Seventeen**	A construct legalist who records requests from temporary roles seeking permanent existence.
4	**Shard Hound Bristle**	A ceramic quadruped trained to locate memory fragments across battlefields.
5	**Kiln Guard Vermilion Five**	A heavily armored construct who prevents outsiders from controlling Court repair facilities.
6	**Foreign Advocate Jessa Pell**	A tiefling barrister who challenges laws classifying artificial soldiers as property or salvage.

